

Granny

AI Companion Platform Dream Book

A formal vision for an AI-first personal computer for older adults

Working premise: The user should not need to learn how to operate a computer. The computer should learn how to operate itself for the user.

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The name “Granny” is used as a working product name in this document. The final brand can change without changing the product thesis.

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1 Executive Definition

1.1 One-line explainer

Granny is an AI-first personal computer for older adults that can talk, remember, understand the screen, and operate the device on the user's behalf.

1.2 Short explainer

Granny combines a simple tablet, an always-available voice companion, and an AI agent that can use the device like a person. Instead of forcing an older adult to learn apps, menus, passwords, settings, and workflows, Granny lets them ask naturally for what they want. The AI can open applications, find information, navigate interfaces, prepare actions, explain what is happening, and safely complete tasks with the user's permission. At the same time, it develops a persistent understanding of the user's family, routines, preferences, memories, stories, and relationships, becoming a long-term companion rather than a collection of disconnected commands.

1.3 One-paragraph explainer

Granny is a purpose-built AI companion and personal computing platform designed for older adults who do not want to become technology experts. The system combines conversational voice interaction, a simplified touch interface, persistent personal memory, family and caregiver support, and an AI device operator capable of controlling normal Android applications. A user can say things such as “show me the photos Sophie sent last week,” “call my daughter,” “make the text bigger,” “find the restaurant David told me about,” or “I don't understand this screen, help me,” and the agent can reason through the request, operate the tablet, ask for confirmation when necessary, and recover when something goes wrong. Over time, the companion also learns the user's life story, relationships, routines, preferences, and important events, turning everyday conversation into a durable personal archive for the user and their family. The goal is not to create a better voice assistant. The goal is to create a computer that increasingly operates itself for the person using it.

1.4 The product thesis

The core thesis is that modern computing is structurally hostile to people who are not comfortable navigating interfaces. Most technology assumes that the human will learn the operating system, understand application conventions, maintain credentials, interpret alerts, remember where information lives, and recover from unexpected states. For a highly technical person, these expectations are ordinary. For many older adults, they are the product failure.

Granny reverses the model:

- The human expresses intent in natural language.
- The AI translates intent into a plan.
- The AI uses the device, applications, and services on the user's behalf.
- The AI explains what it is doing in simple language.
- The AI asks for approval before consequential actions.

- The AI remembers enough context that the user does not need to repeatedly re-explain their life.
- The human can still touch and use the device directly whenever they want.

The end state is a personal computer whose primary interface is not a grid of applications. Its primary interface is a trusted, persistent agent.

2 Why Granny Exists

2.1 The underlying problem

The problem is not that older adults lack access to technology. Many already own smartphones, tablets, televisions, smart speakers, and computers. The problem is that the interaction model remains too demanding.

A normal device repeatedly asks the user to answer questions such as:

- Which app contains the thing I want?
- Where is the right button?
- What does this icon mean?
- Why did the screen change?
- Where did the file download?
- Why did I get logged out?
- Is this notification important?
- What password is this asking for?
- Did my message actually send?
- Why is the text suddenly too small?
- How do I get back to where I was?

Granny should absorb this complexity.

2.2 The deeper opportunity

The opportunity is larger than accessibility. Once an agent can operate the computer and understand the user's personal context, the system can become the interface to a person's digital life.

It can help with communication, media, photos, scheduling, information, travel, household administration, family coordination, storytelling, memory, routine, and social connection. For the user, this removes friction. For the family, it reduces the recurring burden of remote technical support. For the product, it creates a long-term relationship that grows more useful as it learns.

2.3 The north-star promise

If the user can explain what they want in ordinary language, Granny should either do it, help them do it, or clearly explain why it cannot safely be done.

3 Who the Product Is For

3.1 Primary user

The primary user is an older adult who may be perfectly capable, independent, and socially active, but who does not want to learn or maintain the complexity of modern digital systems.

The product should not assume cognitive impairment. It should assume that technology is a means to an end, not a hobby.

Common user characteristics may include:

- comfortable speaking, less comfortable navigating layered interfaces;
- wants to call family, view photos, listen to music, watch videos, manage appointments, and find information;
- may struggle with small controls, changing interfaces, password prompts, popups, app updates, and inconsistent navigation;
- may repeatedly ask family members for technical help;
- values continuity, familiarity, clear explanations, and human-like patience;
- may have mild hearing, vision, dexterity, or memory limitations, but the product should remain useful without any medical framing.

3.2 Secondary user: family

A daughter, son, grandchild, spouse, or trusted family member may help configure the system and occasionally assist remotely.

Their goals are different:

- make the device easy to use without constant instruction;
- add contacts, appointments, photos, music, or accounts;
- help remotely when something breaks;
- know that important settings remain intact;
- reduce technical-support calls without reducing human contact;
- preserve meaningful family stories and memories over time.

3.3 Tertiary users

Depending on product direction, trusted helpers may include professional caregivers, retirement communities, assisted-living staff, or other authorized supporters. Their permissions must be narrower and more explicit than family access.

4 Product Principles

4.1 Human principles

1. **Preserve agency.** The AI assists and operates, but the user remains the owner of the device and the final authority over important actions.
2. **Never make the user feel stupid.** The system should explain, repair, and adapt without condescension.
3. **Speak plainly.** Use ordinary language, concrete options, and visible confirmation.
4. **Remember appropriately.** The user should not have to re-explain basic relationships and preferences every day.
5. **Earn trust through behavior.** Show what will happen before consequential actions and clearly report what happened afterward.
6. **Stay useful when voice fails.** Touch should remain simple, visible, and fully usable.

4.2 Technical principles

1. **Use APIs first.** If a task can be completed reliably through a supported system or app API, prefer that path.
2. **Use semantic UI control second.** When APIs are unavailable, use the accessibility and UI hierarchy.
3. **Use vision and coordinate control last.** Screenshot understanding and raw taps are a fallback, not the default.
4. **Verify every meaningful action.** The agent should check that its action changed the device into the intended state.
5. **Make autonomy permissioned.** The level of autonomy should depend on the action category and user preference.
6. **Design for recovery.** Unexpected screens, popups, network errors, login prompts, and app changes are normal states, not edge cases.

4.3 Product principles

1. The product is not an app launcher with voice commands layered on top.
2. The AI should increasingly become the user's interface to the device.
3. Existing apps remain valuable. Granny should operate them rather than rebuild every vertical from scratch.
4. The companion relationship should become more useful over months and years.
5. Hardware should make the system feel like an appliance and companion, not a fragile general-purpose tablet setup.

5 The End-State Product

5.1 Physical form

The ideal product consists of two integrated components:

1. **A tablet display:** large, bright, touch-friendly, detachable, and usable independently.
2. **A companion base:** a compact cylindrical or softly sculpted dock containing far-field microphones, speakers, tactile controls, status lighting, power, and a magnetic mechanical docking system.

The tablet should dock with a satisfying, obvious motion. Magnets provide alignment and retention. The user should not need to orient cables or understand connectors. Ideally, power and data connect automatically when docked.

The base remains in a familiar location such as a kitchen counter, bedside table, living room table, or desk. The tablet can be removed for reading, video calls, travel around the home, or conventional touch interaction.

5.2 The device should feel like a companion appliance

The user's mental model should not be "this is my Android tablet." It should be closer to "this is Granny, and Granny has a screen."

That difference matters. The system should feel persistent, ambient, and personal. Docked mode emphasizes voice, presence, audio, reminders, and shared viewing. Handheld mode emphasizes touch, reading, photos, video, and mobility.

5.3 Core physical controls

The final device should include only controls that remain valuable when software is confusing or unavailable:

- a prominent talk / ask button;
- volume up and down or a large physical rotary control;
- a physical microphone mute control with unmistakable visual feedback;
- optional dedicated help button;
- clear charging and connectivity indication;
- no dense keyboard of specialized hardware buttons.

6 The Interaction Model

6.1 The primary interface is intent

The user should be able to begin with ordinary requests:

"Call Sophie."

"Show me the pictures from Italy."

"What did David send me yesterday?"

“Make this bigger.”

“I don’t know what this screen is asking me.”

“Find the restaurant Mark told me about.”

“Play the music we listened to yesterday.”

“I was reading something before lunch. Can you take me back?”

The system is responsible for resolving ambiguity, selecting the right application, planning the steps, performing the task, and explaining what happened.

6.2 Three modes of interaction

6.2.1 Conversational mode

The user talks naturally. The screen supports the conversation with cards, photos, names, large confirmation buttons, transcriptions, and visual context.

6.2.2 Direct touch mode

The user can use normal applications and Granny’s simplified launcher directly. The AI remains available but does not constantly interfere.

6.2.3 Co-pilot mode

The user starts manually, becomes confused, and asks for help. Granny inspects the current state and continues from where the user is.

Example:

User: “I was trying to send this photo to Sophie and now I don’t know what happened.”

Granny: “You’re in the sharing menu. Sophie is here. I can select her and prepare the message. Want me to do that?”

7 The AI Device Operator

7.1 Definition

The device operator is the execution layer that gives the companion agency over the computer. It should not merely recommend steps. It should be able to perform them.

The agent should have access to structured device capabilities such as:

- current application and screen state;
- semantic accessibility tree;
- visible text and controls;
- screenshots when necessary;
- open application;
- click control;

- enter text;
- scroll;
- back / home navigation;
- notifications;
- audio, display, and selected device settings;
- permissions and account-state diagnostics;
- approved app-specific integrations;
- task-state verification.

7.2 The operator loop

For every non-trivial task, the end-state operator should follow an explicit loop:

1. **Understand:** interpret user intent and relevant personal context.
2. **Plan:** choose applications, tools, and a sequence of actions.
3. **Inspect:** read current device state.
4. **Act:** perform the next safe action.
5. **Verify:** confirm that the expected result occurred.
6. **Recover:** if the state differs from expectation, re-plan.
7. **Confirm:** before consequential actions, obtain explicit approval.
8. **Report:** tell the user what was completed in plain language.

7.3 How far the operator should be pushed

The long-term ambition should be broad. If a task is something a competent human could reasonably do on the tablet, Granny should aspire to help complete it.

Examples include:

- communication across messaging, calling, and email applications;
- photos and media browsing;
- calendar and reminders;
- information lookup and web navigation;
- travel documents and simple trip information;
- music, video, podcasts, and audiobooks;
- household portals and service websites;
- forms and appointment preparation;
- accessibility and device settings;

- downloading, opening, and locating files;
- helping the user understand unfamiliar screens or error messages;
- navigating apps that have no dedicated Granny integration.

The limiting principle is not technical ambition. It is user safety and permission.

8 The Senior-First Home Experience

8.1 The launcher

The default home screen should not expose a dense general-purpose Android layout. It should show only the information and actions that matter.

A representative home state:

```
+-----+
|               |
|      Good morning, Barbara      |
|               |
|             9:42                |
|               |
|      What can I help with?      |
|               |
|      [  ASK ME  ]               |
|               |
|  FAMILY    PHOTOS    MUSIC     |
|               |
|      TODAY          HELP        |
|               |
+-----+
```

8.2 Dynamic simplicity

The home screen should adapt slowly, not chaotically. Frequently used actions may become more prominent, but the user should never feel that the layout is constantly rearranging itself.

The AI can recommend contextually useful actions without turning the interface into a feed of suggestions.

Examples:

- “Sophie usually calls on Sundays.”
- “You have a dentist appointment tomorrow at 10:30.”
- “David sent three new photos.”
- “Would you like to continue the book you were reading?”

8.3 When normal apps are visible

Granny should not hide the existence of apps entirely. Sometimes the user will want the familiar Spotify, YouTube, Photos, browser, or messaging interface. The difference is that Granny remains able to help inside those applications.

9 Persistent Memory and Personal Understanding

9.1 Memory is a product feature, not a transcript archive

The end-state system should build structured understanding of the user over time. This should include facts, relationships, routines, preferences, recurring events, meaningful stories, and unresolved threads.

The goal is not to remember everything. The goal is to remember what makes future assistance more useful and personal.

9.2 Personal knowledge graph

A simplified representation could include:

```
BARBARA
|
+-- family
|   +-- Sophie, daughter, Boston
|   +-- David, son, Chicago
|   +-- Robert, late husband
|
+-- routines
|   +-- coffee around 8:00
|   +-- Sophie usually calls Sundays
|   +-- evening television after dinner
|
+-- preferences
|   +-- Frank Sinatra
|   +-- gardening
|   +-- mystery novels
|
+-- memories
|   +-- met Robert at university
|   +-- honeymoon in Rome
|   +-- first home in Ann Arbor
|
+-- upcoming
    +-- dentist Thursday 10:30
    +-- Sophie visiting next month
```

9.3 Memory categories

Memory should be separated into at least the following conceptual classes:

- **Identity:** preferred name, communication style, important settings.
- **Relationships:** family, friends, caregivers, relationship context.
- **Preferences:** music, food, entertainment, routines, interface preferences.
- **Logistics:** recurring appointments, household details, known service providers.
- **Stories:** rich autobiographical memories collected through conversation.
- **Threads:** promises, plans, unanswered questions, things to revisit.
- **Interaction history:** recent actions and device context useful for continuity.

9.4 Memory controls

The user should be able to ask:

“What do you remember about Sophie?”

“Don’t remember that.”

“That story is private.”

“You got Robert’s birthday wrong.”

The system should make correction, review, and deletion understandable without requiring the user to navigate a database-like memory manager.

10 Life Story and Legacy

10.1 The emotional wedge

One of the strongest long-term differentiators is that everyday conversation can gradually create something meaningful beyond the immediate task.

When the user tells stories, Granny can identify people, places, dates, relationships, photographs, and themes. Over months or years, these fragments can form a life archive.

10.2 Story capture experience

Granny should never turn normal conversation into an interrogation. It can gently return to unfinished stories when appropriate.

Example:

“Yesterday you mentioned meeting Robert at university. You said your first date went completely wrong, but we never finished the story. What happened?”

The resulting artifact may include:

- original voice recording;
- transcript;
- cleaned narrative version;
- linked people and places;

- relevant family photographs;
- approximate dates;
- optional family annotations;
- uncertainty markers when the system is unsure.

10.3 Generated artifacts

Over time, the product could create:

- a private life-story book;
- family timeline;
- audio memoir;
- “stories about Robert” collection;
- travel memory albums;
- birthday or anniversary compilations;
- family-tree narrative;
- annual “year with Granny” archive.

The user should control which artifacts are private, shared, or exportable.

11 Companion Behavior

11.1 The companion is not merely reactive

The final product should support carefully bounded proactive behavior. The companion can check in, remind, reconnect threads, and surface meaningful information without becoming nagging or intrusive.

11.2 Daily rhythm

A possible daily experience:

Morning: “Good morning, Barbara. You have one appointment today at 2:00. Would you like the weather and your schedule?”

Midday: “Sophie sent you three photos. Want to see them?”

Afternoon: “You asked me yesterday to remind you to call the pharmacy. Would you like me to open their number?”

Evening: “You told me a wonderful story about Rome today. I made a short page from it. Want to hear it?”

11.3 Proactivity should be earned

The product should learn the user’s desired level of initiative. Some users may want an active companion. Others may want the system to stay silent unless addressed.

A simple internal preference could range from:

Quiet Helpful Proactive

This preference should be adjustable in natural language.

12 Communication and Social Connection

12.1 Calls and messages

The product should make family communication radically easier.

Examples:

“Call Sophie.”

“Send David the photo on the screen.”

“Tell Mark I’ll be there around six.”

“Who messaged me today?”

“What did Anna say about Sunday?”

12.2 Message preparation and confirmation

The system can prepare low-risk communication, but it should make the final content visible and easy to approve.

Example:

Granny: “I can send Sophie: ‘I’ll call you after dinner.’ Send it?”

Large controls:

SEND

CHANGE IT

CANCEL

12.3 Context across communication channels

The long-term system should be able to help the user navigate communication history regardless of which application contains it, subject to permissions and platform constraints.

The user should think in terms of people and conversations, not application silos.

13 Photos, Media, and Personal Content

13.1 Photos as memory, not file management

Users should not need to remember which photo application or folder contains something.

Examples:

“Show me pictures of Sophie’s wedding.”
“Find the photo of the house in Rome.”
“Show me the pictures David sent last week.”
“Put these into an album called Christmas 2025.”

13.2 Media

Granny should mediate entertainment naturally:

“Play Frank Sinatra.”
“Put on the show we watched yesterday.”
“Make it a little quieter.”
“Find me a gardening video about tomatoes.”

The agent should prefer direct service integrations when reliable, but remain able to operate visible interfaces when needed.

14 Calendar, Routines, and Everyday Organization

The product should become a calm interface to everyday logistics.

Capabilities can include:

- show today’s schedule;
- explain upcoming appointments;
- create reminders;
- prepare calls related to appointments;
- surface travel timing and locations;
- keep track of things the user said they intended to do;
- reconnect unfinished tasks;
- help locate tickets, documents, or confirmation emails;
- summarize only the information relevant to the user right now.

Granny should avoid turning life into a productivity dashboard. The design goal is orientation, not optimization.

15 The Family and Caregiver Layer

15.1 Purpose

The family layer exists to make support easier without turning the device into surveillance technology.

A trusted family member should be able to help configure and maintain the device, while the older adult remains in control of personal content and privacy.

15.2 Family capabilities

Depending on granted permissions, a trusted family member may be able to:

- add or edit trusted contacts;
- add appointments or reminders;
- send photos or albums to the device;
- configure accessibility preferences;
- add services or account connections;
- troubleshoot connectivity;
- view device health such as battery or connectivity;
- start an approved remote-assistance session;
- contribute names or context to family photos and stories;
- receive selected user-approved summaries or alerts.

15.3 What family should not automatically see

Family access should not imply access to:

- private conversations with Granny;
- message contents;
- browsing history;
- personal stories marked private;
- full microphone history;
- arbitrary screen viewing;
- financial or account credentials.

Any broader access must be explicit, understandable, revocable, and visible to the user.

16 Safety, Trust, and Autonomy

16.1 Autonomy tiers

The AI should classify actions by consequence.

Tier	Example actions	Default behavior
Green	Open app, play music, show photos, change volume, navigate back, search, enlarge text	Execute directly, then report if useful

Yellow	Send message, initiate call, share photo, create appointment, delete ordinary content, change account preference	Prepare action and request clear confirmation
Red	Purchases, banking, password changes, account recovery, legal agreements, installation of unknown software, security settings	Strong confirmation, possible additional authentication, or refuse delegation

16.2 Visible agency

The user should always be able to understand when the AI is acting. The system should avoid invisible chains of consequential actions.

Useful patterns include:

- “I found Sophie’s chat.”
- “I drafted the message, but I have not sent it.”
- “This screen is asking for a password. I won’t enter or reveal one without you.”
- “The app changed unexpectedly, so I stopped.”

16.3 Undo and recovery

Whenever technically possible, Granny should provide a simple undo path.

Example:

“I moved the photo into the album. If that was wrong, I can put it back.”

16.4 Confidence-aware behavior

The system should distinguish between:

- “I know exactly what this control does.”
- “This appears to be the right button, but I’m not certain.”
- “I don’t understand this screen safely enough to act.”

Low confidence should lead to clarification, safe inspection, or asking the user for help rather than confident guessing.

17 Privacy and Data Philosophy

17.1 Privacy must be understandable

The intended user should not need to understand data architecture to understand privacy.

The product should be able to answer questions such as:

“Are you listening right now?”
“Who can see this story?”
“What do you remember about me?”
“Can Sophie see our conversations?”

with short, direct answers.

17.2 Core privacy principles

1. Store only what serves a clear product purpose.
2. Separate private companion memory from family-shared information.
3. Make microphone state physically obvious.
4. Make remote-access sessions visible on the device.
5. Support natural-language review and deletion of stored memories.
6. Do not silently expand caregiver visibility.
7. Treat credentials, financial data, and highly sensitive information as separate trust domains.

18 Failure Handling

18.1 The product must be designed for broken states

Real-world mobile interfaces fail constantly. Apps update. Buttons move. Networks drop. Permissions expire. Login screens appear. Popups interrupt workflows. Granny’s reliability depends less on perfect first actions and more on graceful recovery.

18.2 Failure classes

The system should explicitly recognize:

- application not installed;
- app signed out;
- permission missing;
- network unavailable;
- content not found;
- accessibility tree insufficient;
- UI changed since previous model assumption;
- ambiguous person or object;
- destructive action risk;
- unsupported security boundary;
- user manually changed the device during execution.

18.3 How Granny should fail

Bad failure:

“Something went wrong.”

Good failure:

“WhatsApp is asking you to sign in again. I can’t safely complete that part for you. I can stay here and explain each step.”

The user should know what happened, what the system can still do, and what human input is required.

19 End-State Technical Architecture

19.1 Layered model

The final platform can be thought of as six layers:

COMPANION EXPERIENCE
voice, personality, memory, routines, stories
SAFETY / POLICY
permissions, confirmations, action boundaries
AGENT BRAIN
planning, reasoning, tool selection, recovery
DEVICE OPERATOR
APIs, UI tree, screenshots, gestures, validation
SENIOR SHELL
launcher, assistant, notifications, accessibility
ANDROID / AOSP
apps, services, hardware, connectivity

19.2 Model independence

The intelligence layer should not be permanently coupled to a single foundation model provider.

The system may use different models for different tasks:

- fast conversational model;
- stronger planner for difficult device tasks;
- vision model for ambiguous interfaces;
- local wake-word or audio processing;

- specialized summarization or memory extraction;
- future on-device models as hardware improves.

The proprietary product layer should be the combination of device control, senior UX, memory, family system, safety logic, and long-term behavioral data, not dependence on one model's intelligence.

19.3 When a custom Android fork becomes valuable

A custom Android / AOSP layer is justified when stock Android prevents reliable delivery of the intended experience.

Possible reasons include:

- stronger system-level accessibility and UI introspection;
- more reliable background assistant execution;
- tighter device-owner control;
- controlled updates and app compatibility;
- simplified provisioning;
- direct system APIs for settings and navigation;
- unified permission mediation;
- deeper integration between hardware controls and companion state;
- improved observability of current device state;
- recovery mechanisms that ordinary apps cannot implement.

The custom OS is a means to reliability, not the product itself.

20 Representative Full Workflows

20.1 Workflow A: Find a family photo from a message

User: "Sophie sent me pictures of her new house last week. Show me those."

Expected system behavior:

1. Resolve "Sophie" from relationship memory.
2. Determine likely messaging channel based on recent history.
3. Open the relevant application.
4. Search or navigate to Sophie's conversation.
5. Identify the relevant date window.
6. Locate image attachments.
7. Open the images full screen.
8. Ask, "Are these the ones you meant?" if confidence is not high.

9. Optionally offer to save them into a named family album.

20.2 Workflow B: User is lost inside an app

User: “I don’t know what I did. Can you fix this?”

Expected behavior:

1. Inspect current application and screen state.
2. Infer likely context from recent actions.
3. Explain simply: “You’re in the settings page for YouTube.”
4. Determine whether returning to the previous task is safe.
5. Offer: “You were watching a gardening video. I can take you back.”
6. Execute back navigation and verify the video page appears.

20.3 Workflow C: Family technical support

Situation: Barbara calls Sophie because “the internet is broken.”

Instead of a 30-minute support call:

1. Granny diagnoses Wi-Fi status and router connectivity.
2. It explains: “The tablet is connected to Wi-Fi, but the internet connection is not working.”
3. With Barbara’s approval, Sophie opens a remote support session.
4. Barbara sees a persistent “Sophie is helping” banner.
5. Sophie can view the relevant settings screen, not unrestricted private content.
6. Once fixed, remote access ends automatically.

20.4 Workflow D: Story becomes family artifact

User: spends 20 minutes telling Granny about meeting Robert.

The system:

1. records or transcribes with permission;
2. identifies Robert, university, approximate year, and related family context;
3. stores the story as a private memory;
4. asks later whether Barbara wants it added to her life story;
5. links existing photos if confidence is high;
6. creates a short polished chapter;
7. allows Barbara to listen to it, edit details by voice, and decide whether Sophie can see it.

20.5 Workflow E: Everyday communication

User: “Tell David I’ll call tonight after dinner.”

The system:

1. resolves which David the user means;
2. selects the usual communication channel;
3. drafts the message;
4. reads it aloud or displays it;
5. asks for confirmation;
6. sends only after approval;
7. verifies that the application reports successful sending.

21 Capability Map

21.1 Communication

- call family and trusted contacts;
- video call;
- prepare and send messages;
- read recent incoming messages when permitted;
- find historical conversations;
- share photos and links;
- explain suspicious or confusing messages without automatically acting on them.

21.2 Media and entertainment

- play specific music, artists, playlists, radio, podcasts, audiobooks;
- continue previously played content;
- find videos by description rather than exact title;
- control volume, captions, playback, and screen size;
- recommend familiar content based on user preference without turning into an engagement feed.

21.3 Photos and memories

- search by person, place, date, event, or remembered context;
- locate photos inside messaging applications;
- create albums;
- display family photo slideshows;

- connect photos to life stories;
- help identify unknown people with family input.

21.4 Device help

- enlarge text;
- increase contrast;
- change volume and brightness;
- understand and dismiss harmless popups;
- explain errors;
- reconnect to known Wi-Fi;
- find downloaded files;
- locate applications;
- return the user to a previous task;
- guide secure login when required.

21.5 Personal organization

- calendar;
- reminders;
- recurring routines;
- appointment context;
- travel details;
- simple household tasks;
- family birthdays and anniversaries;
- “things I said I would do” reminders.

21.6 Companionship and storytelling

- daily conversation;
- continuity across previous stories;
- gentle questions about meaningful memories;
- family context;
- music and photos connected to memories;
- life-story generation;
- reflective summaries;
- optional family sharing.

22 What Granny Should Not Become

22.1 Not a replacement for family

The system should make family connection easier, not simulate that human relationships are unnecessary.

22.2 Not a surveillance system

Caregivers should not silently receive full transcripts, screen activity, or private conversations.

22.3 Not a medical authority

The product may eventually integrate with wellness and health systems, but it should not present itself as a physician or autonomously make high-stakes medical decisions.

22.4 Not a manipulative engagement product

Success is not measured by maximizing screen time or conversation time. A good outcome may be that the user quickly completes a task and goes on with their day.

22.5 Not an AI that hides uncertainty

When the agent does not know, it should say so. Trust is more important than maintaining the appearance of intelligence.

23 The Final User Experience in One Day

Imagine Barbara, age 78, living independently.

At 8:30, she walks into the kitchen. The tablet is docked. Granny says nothing until Barbara presses the large talk button.

Barbara: “What’s happening today?”

Granny: “You have lunch with Anne at 12:30 and a dentist appointment tomorrow morning. Sophie sent two photos last night. Want to see them?”

Barbara says yes. The screen opens the photos. She removes the tablet from the magnetic dock and looks at them.

At 10:00, she opens Facebook manually, taps into the wrong menu, and says:

“I can’t get back to the thing I was looking at.”

Granny inspects the screen, explains where she is, and takes her back.

At noon, Barbara asks:

“What was the name of that restaurant David told me about?”

Granny searches the relevant conversation, finds the restaurant, shows it, and offers directions.

After lunch, Barbara tells Granny a story about her first apartment with Robert. The conversation lasts fifteen minutes. Granny remembers the story but does not share it.

At 4:00, Barbara says:

“Tell Sophie I’m tired today but I’ll call tomorrow.”

Granny drafts the message and asks Barbara to approve it before sending.

At 7:00, the companion asks whether Barbara wants to hear the short story page it created from the afternoon conversation. Barbara listens and corrects the year. Granny updates it.

At no point did Barbara need to know which application contained a photo, which messaging service Sophie used, what menu Facebook opened, where a downloaded file lived, or how to troubleshoot the tablet. She expressed intent. The computer absorbed the interface complexity.

That is the end-state experience.

24 The Dream-State Product Definition

A fully realized Granny system has succeeded when the following statements are true:

1. The user can accomplish most ordinary tablet tasks by describing the desired outcome rather than navigating the interface.
2. The AI can reliably inspect, operate, verify, and recover across a broad range of Android applications.
3. The user can always take direct control through touch.
4. Consequential actions require clear, understandable approval.
5. The interface is calm enough that a person can use it every day without technology becoming the subject of the interaction.
6. The system remembers relationships, preferences, routines, and stories sufficiently to create genuine continuity.
7. Family can help with configuration and troubleshooting without automatically gaining access to private content.
8. The physical device feels like a coherent product, not a tablet attached to a smart speaker.
9. The system becomes more useful over time without becoming more confusing.
10. The user can ask “Can you do this for me?” far more often than “How do I do this?”

25 Strategic Moat

The long-term defensibility should not be that a foundation model can press buttons. Large AI platforms and operating-system vendors will continue to improve that capability.

The moat should come from the integrated system:

- senior-specific interaction design;
- deeply reliable device-operation layer;
- long-term personal and family memory graph;

- permissioned caregiver infrastructure;
- life-story and legacy archive;
- safety and action-confirmation architecture;
- hardware-software integration;
- longitudinal understanding of what older adults actually ask computers to do;
- trust built through years of useful, predictable behavior.

The product should be model-agnostic enough to benefit whenever underlying AI improves.

26 Ultimate Vision

Granny should become the layer between an older adult and the digital world. The person speaks in goals, questions, memories, and ordinary human language. Granny translates those intentions into digital actions, while preserving control, privacy, familiarity, and dignity.

The ambition is not to simplify every app manually. It is not to build a closed ecosystem of senior-specific substitutes. It is to create a trusted agent that can understand the user, understand the computer, and bridge the two.

At full maturity, the product is simultaneously:

- a conversational companion;
- a device operator;
- a simple personal computer;
- a memory and life-story archive;
- a bridge to family;
- a support layer for the digital world;
- a persistent interface that grows with the user over time.

The defining product question should remain simple:

Can the user live their life without needing to become good at computers?

If the answer increasingly becomes yes, Granny is working.

A Appendix A: Example Natural-Language Requests

The following examples illustrate the intended breadth of the final product. They are not a strict feature checklist.

Category	Example requests
Family	“Call Sophie.” “Show me what David sent yesterday.” “Send this photo to Anne.” “When is Mark visiting?”
Photos	“Show me our Italy pictures.” “Find the photo from Sophie’s wedding.” “Put these in an album.”
Messages	“Tell David I’ll call tonight.” “Who messaged me today?” “Find the restaurant Anna sent me.”
Media	“Play Frank Sinatra.” “Continue the show from last night.” “Find me something about gardening.”
Device help	“Make this bigger.” “What is this screen asking me?” “Take me back.” “Why isn’t the sound working?”
Calendar	“What’s happening tomorrow?” “Remind me to call the pharmacy.” “When is my dentist appointment?”
Web	“Find the opening hours for the museum.” “Show me the menu.” “Where did I read that article?”
Files	“Open the plane ticket I downloaded.” “Where is the document Sophie sent me?”
Memory	“What did I tell you about Robert?” “When did we go to Rome?” “Remember that Sophie hates olives.”
Storytelling	“I want to tell you about my first job.” “Read me the story you made yesterday.”
Help	“I don’t know what I did.” “Can you finish this for me?” “I don’t understand this message.”

B Appendix B: Product Language

B.1 Preferred framing

Use language such as:

- “I can do that.”
- “I found it.”
- “I prepared the message. Want me to send it?”
- “This app is asking you to sign in.”
- “I am not certain enough to press that safely.”
- “Would you like me to take you back?”

Avoid framing that makes the user responsible for understanding system internals unless absolutely necessary.

B.2 Core brand sentence

Granny is the computer you can simply ask.